

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete Nimzo-Indian Defense

e4 control, structural decisions, major White systems, and dynamic equality

COURSE BOOK

20 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

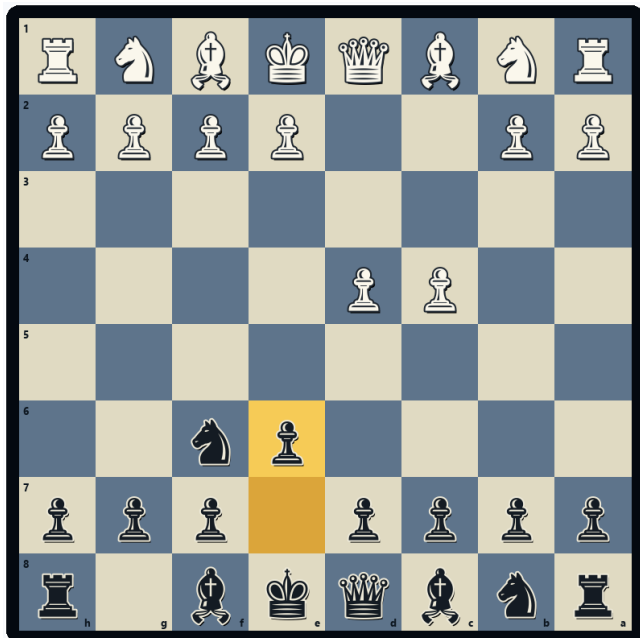
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
01 - Foundation	2
02 - Rubinstein	4
03 - Classical	4
04 - Saemisch	4
05 - Leningrad	2
06 - f3 Systems	2
07 - Flexible Systems	2

01. Nimzo-Indian Core - Move Order



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Nimzo-Indian Core structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4, gains the bishop pair, or uses Qc2 to avoid doubled pawns.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo-Indian Core.

01. Decision Framework

Nimzo-Indian Core - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

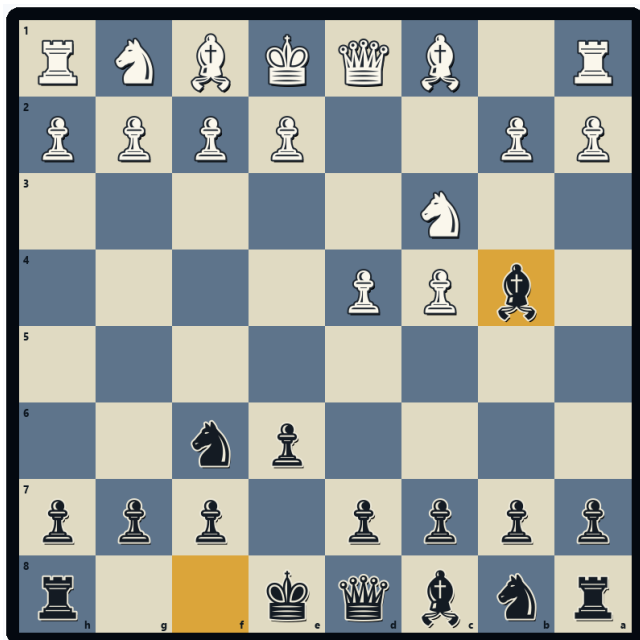
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo-Indian Core.

02. Nimzo-Indian Core



01 - Foundation

READ THE POSITION

Black pins the c3-knight and pressures the center without occupying it with pawns.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose whether to preserve the bishop, damage White's structure, or strike with ...d5 or ...c5.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4, gains the bishop pair, or uses Qc2 to avoid doubled pawns.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4

MEMORY RULE

The Nimzo is about controlling e4 and choosing the right moment to exchange on c3.

02. Decision Framework

Nimzo-Indian Core

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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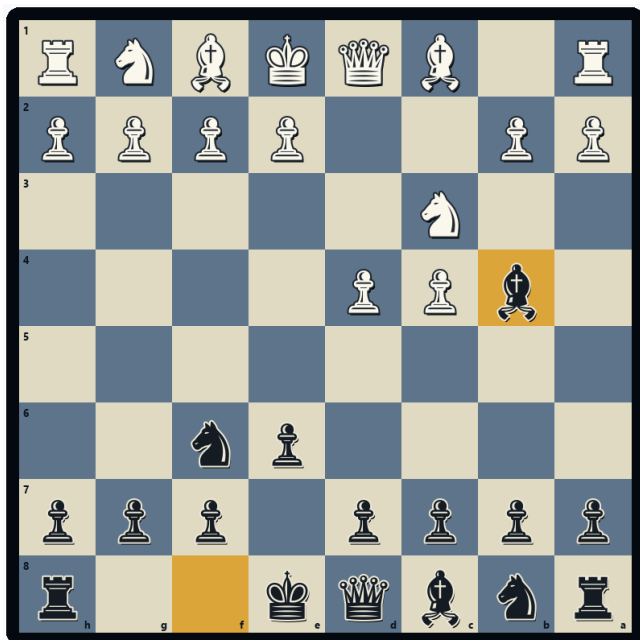
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Nimzo is about controlling e4 and choosing the right moment to exchange on c3.

03. Rubinstein System - Move Order



02 - Rubinstein

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Rubinstein System structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White prepares e4 and may gain the bishop pair without structural damage.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Rubinstein System.

03. Decision Framework

Rubinstein System - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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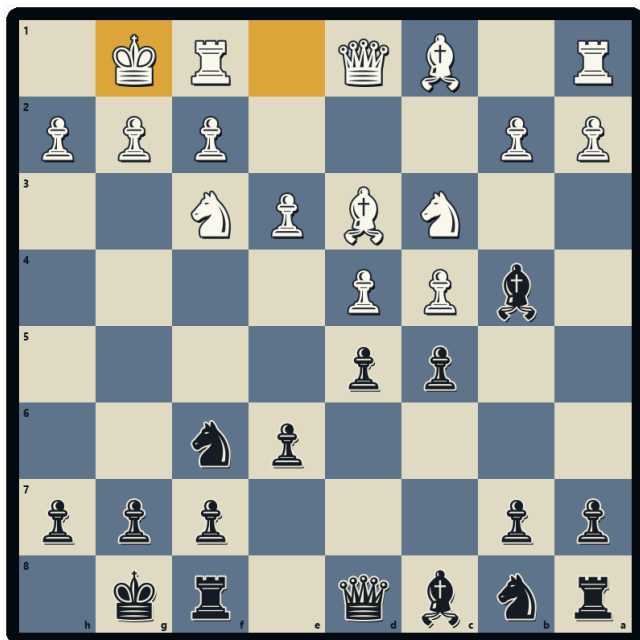
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Rubinstein System.

04. Rubinstein System



02 - Rubinstein

READ THE POSITION

White develops solidly and accepts that Black can define the central structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center, decide whether ...dxc4 or ...c5 improves the pieces, and watch e4.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White prepares e4 and may gain the bishop pair without structural damage.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e3 O-O 5. Bd3 d5 6. Nf3 c5 7. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Against the Rubinstein, central timing matters more than immediate structural damage.

04. Decision Framework

Rubinstein System

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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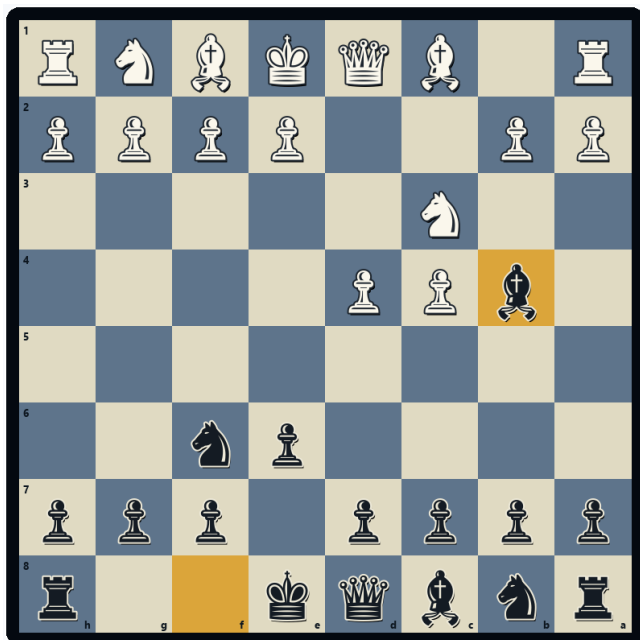
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against the Rubinstein, central timing matters more than immediate structural damage.

05. Classical 4.Qc2 - Move Order



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Classical 4.Qc2 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4 and uses the bishop pair in an open position.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical 4.Qc2.

05. Decision Framework

Classical 4.Qc2 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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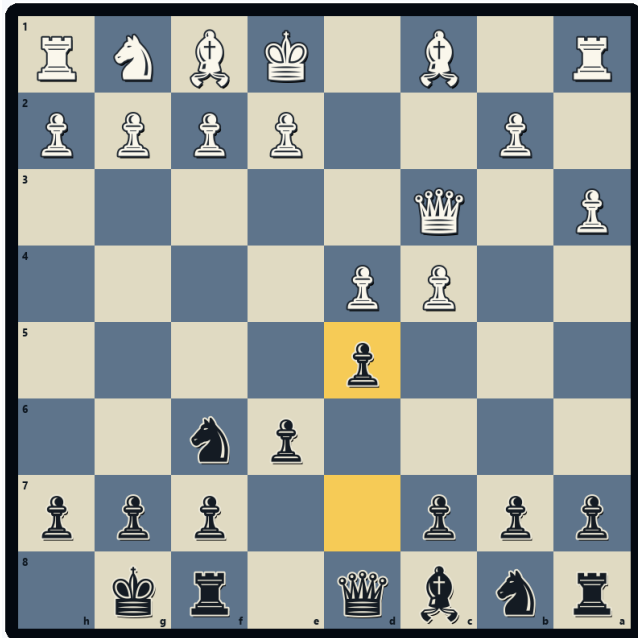
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Classical 4.Qc2.

06. Classical 4.Qc2



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

White avoids doubled pawns and gains the bishop pair while spending queen tempi.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use rapid development and central pressure before the bishops become powerful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4 and uses the bishop pair in an open position.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Qc2 O-O 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. Qxc3 d5

MEMORY RULE

Qc2 preserves structure but gives Black time; use that time actively.

06. Decision Framework

Classical 4.Qc2

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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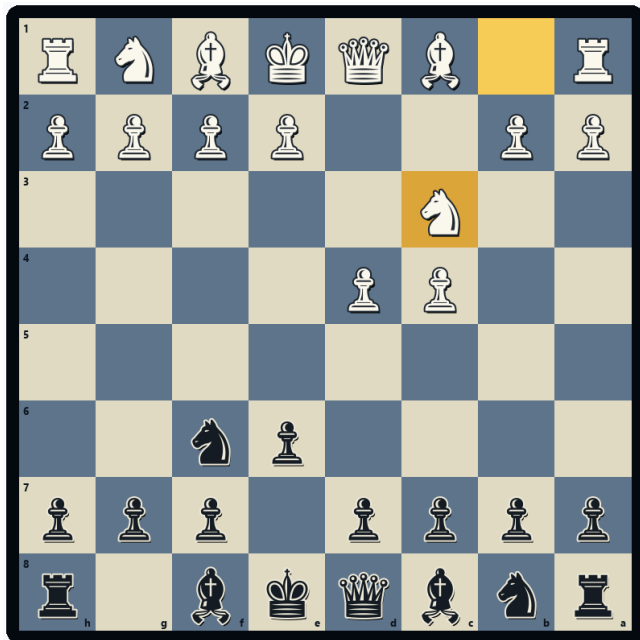
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Qc2 preserves structure but gives Black time; use that time actively.

07. Saemisch Structure - Move Order



04 - Saemisch

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Saemisch Structure structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4 and uses the bishops before the pawns become weak.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Saemisch Structure.

07. Decision Framework

Saemisch Structure - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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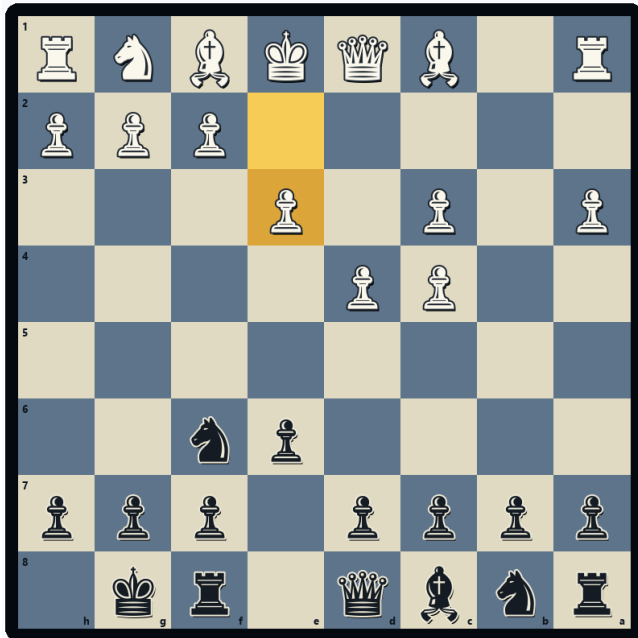
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Saemisch Structure.

08. Saemisch Structure



04 - Saemisch

READ THE POSITION

White accepts doubled c-pawns for the bishop pair and a broad center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Attack the pawn center with ...c5 or ...d5 and exploit the c-file targets.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White builds e4 and uses the bishops before the pawns become weak.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. a3 Bxc3+ 5. bxc3 O-O 6. e3

MEMORY RULE

The doubled pawns are dynamic first and weak later; challenge them before consolidation.

08. Decision Framework

Saemisch Structure

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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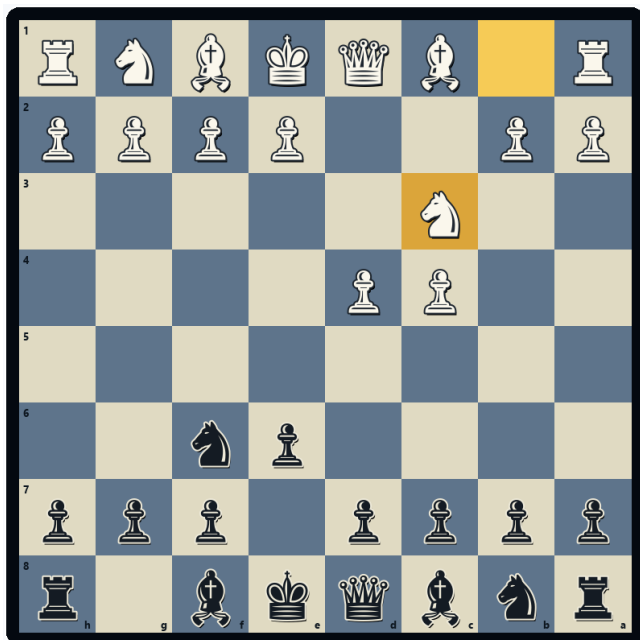
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The doubled pawns are dynamic first and weak later; challenge them before consolidation.

09. Leningrad System - Move Order



05 - Leningrad

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Leningrad System structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains space and may use e4 while Black's bishop sits outside the pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Leningrad System.

09. Decision Framework

Leningrad System - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
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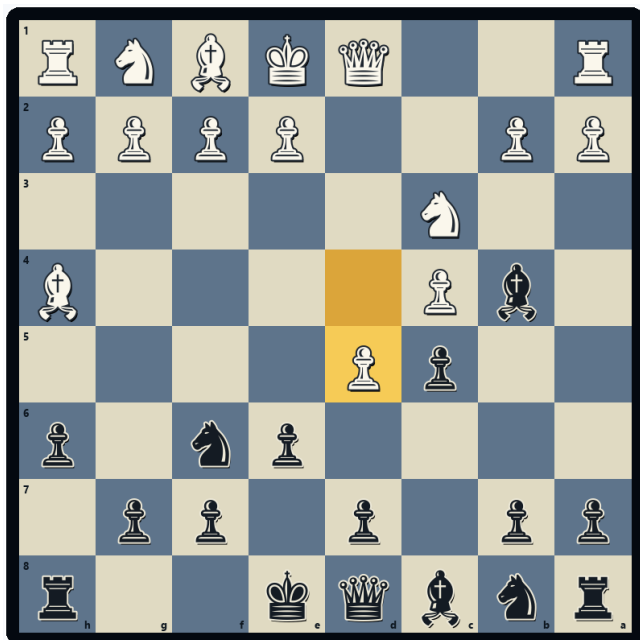
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5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Leningrad System.

10. Leningrad System



05 - Leningrad

READ THE POSITION

White pins the knight and closes the center with d5.

PRIMARY PLAN

Question the bishop, strike at the center, and choose ...d6 or ...exd5 according to piece activity.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains space and may use e4 while Black's bishop sits outside the pawn chain.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Bg5 h6 5. Bh4 c5 6. d5

MEMORY RULE

Closed centers reward the side whose pawn break arrives with better-prepared pieces.

10. Decision Framework

Leningrad System

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
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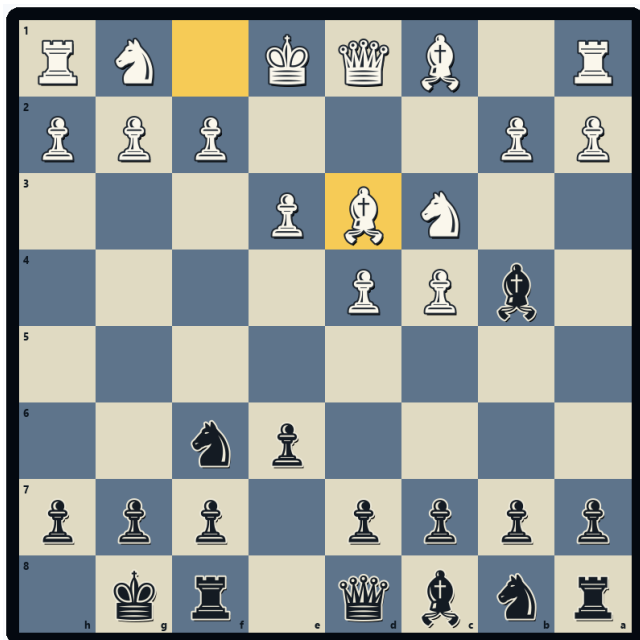
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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Closed centers reward the side whose pawn break arrives with better-prepared pieces.

11. Huebner Variation - Move Order



02 - Rubinstein

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Huebner Variation structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses bishops and e4 to create dynamic play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e3 O-O 5. Bd3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Huebner Variation.

11. Decision Framework

Huebner Variation - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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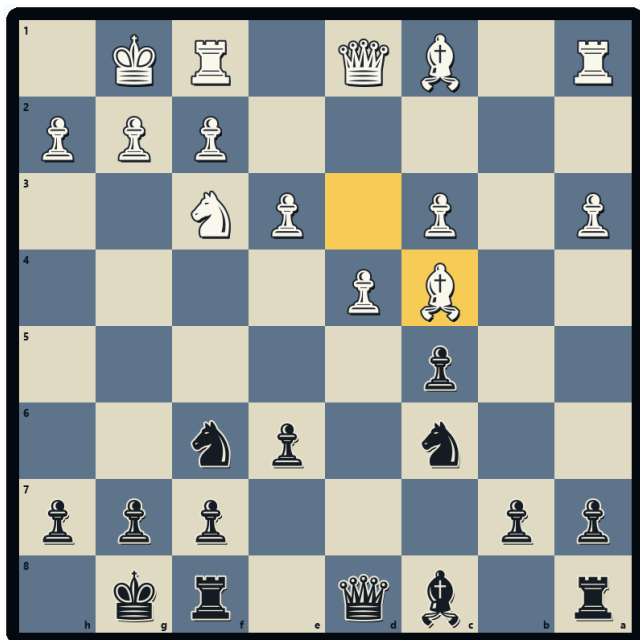
ACTIVE RECALL

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4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Huebner Variation.

12. Huebner Variation



02 - Rubinstein

READ THE POSITION

Black fixes White's structure and accepts the bishop pair in a semi-closed center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Blockade the c-pawns, use dark squares, and free the position only when the structure favors Black.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses bishops and e4 to create dynamic play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e3 O-O 5. Bd3 d5 6. Nf3 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. a3 Bxc3 9. bxc3 dxc4 10. Bxc4

MEMORY RULE

The Huebner system trades bishop potential for a fixed structural target.

12. Decision Framework

Huebner Variation

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: The Huebner system trades bishop potential for a fixed structural target.

13. Nimzo with 4.f3 - Move Order



06 - f3 Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Nimzo with 4.f3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses the broad pawn center and bishop pair for space and attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo with 4.f3.

13. Decision Framework

Nimzo with 4.f3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
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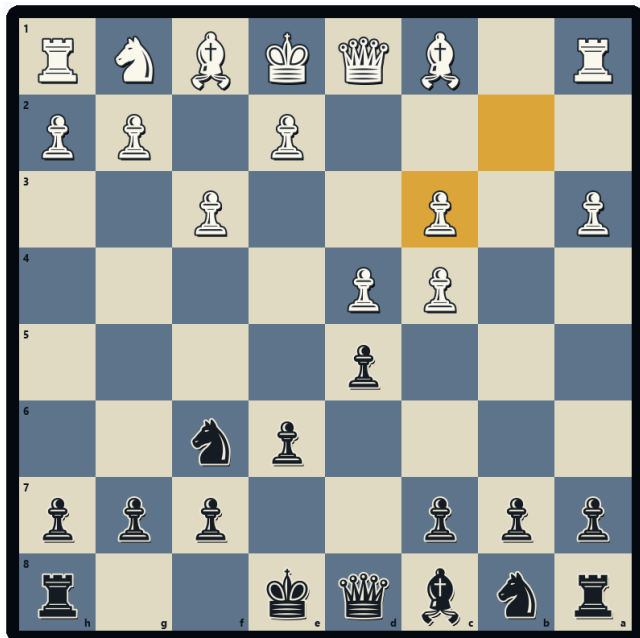
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
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3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo with 4.f3.

14. Nimzo with 4.f3



06 - f3 Systems

READ THE POSITION

White prepares e4 directly and accepts structural risk.

PRIMARY PLAN

Challenge the center before e4 becomes secure and calculate ...c5 breaks.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses the broad pawn center and bishop pair for space and attack.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. f3 d5 5. a3 Bxc3+ 6. bxc3

MEMORY RULE

When White spends time on f3, Black must attack the center before it becomes stable.

14. Decision Framework

Nimzo with 4.f3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When White spends time on f3, Black must attack the center before it becomes stable.

15. Nimzo with 4.Nf3 - Move Order



07 - Flexible Systems

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Nimzo with 4.Nf3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may use e3, Qc2, or g3 without accepting immediate structural damage.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo with 4.Nf3.

15. Decision Framework

Nimzo with 4.Nf3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

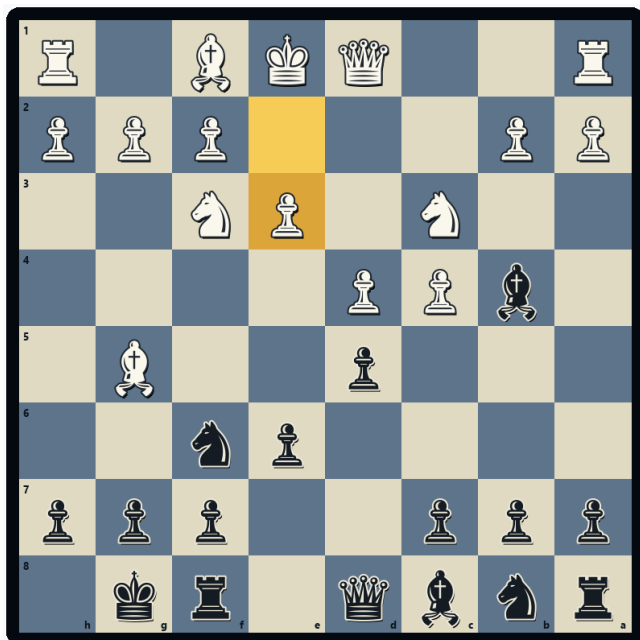
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo with 4.Nf3.

16. Nimzo with 4.Nf3



07 - Flexible Systems

READ THE POSITION

White develops flexibly and can transpose to several Queen's Gambit structures.

PRIMARY PLAN

Keep options for ...d5, ...c5, or ...b6 and read White's next central commitment.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White may use e3, Qc2, or g3 without accepting immediate structural damage.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Nf3 O-O 5. Bg5 d5 6. e3

MEMORY RULE

Flexible systems are answered with flexible development, not a forced label.

16. Decision Framework

Nimzo with 4.Nf3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Flexible systems are answered with flexible development, not a forced label.

17. Nimzo with 4.Qb3 - Move Order



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Nimzo with 4.Qb3 structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks the bishop pair and queenside material without doubled pawns.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo with 4.Qb3.

17. Decision Framework

Nimzo with 4.Qb3 - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

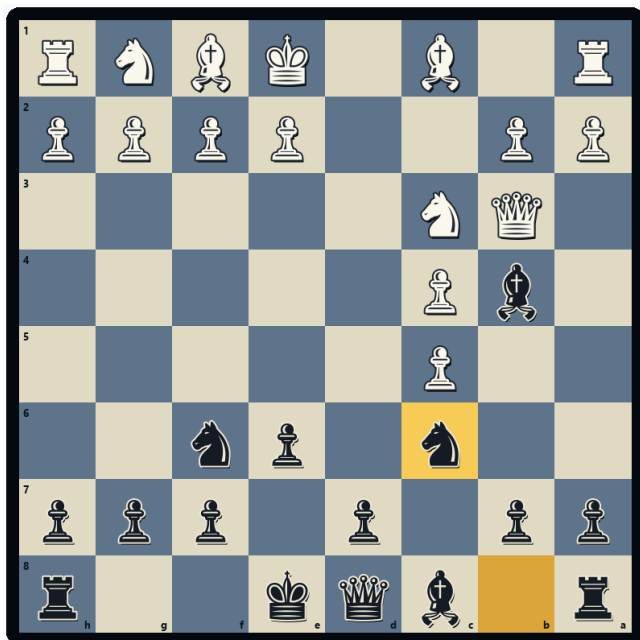
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Nimzo with 4.Qb3.

18. Nimzo with 4.Qb3



03 - Classical

READ THE POSITION

White pressures b4 and b7 while Black attacks the center with tempo.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop through ...Nc6 and use central activity against the exposed queen.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks the bishop pair and queenside material without doubled pawns.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. Qb3 c5 5. dxc5 Nc6

MEMORY RULE

When the queen hunts pawns, gain development and central activity.

18. Decision Framework

Nimzo with 4.Qb3

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

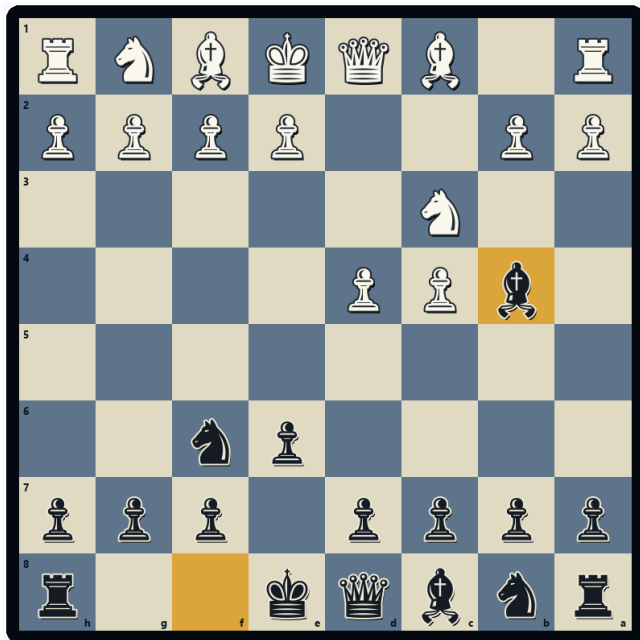
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: When the queen hunts pawns, gain development and central activity.

19. Kmoch Structure - Move Order



04 - Saemisch

READ THE POSITION

Reach the Kmoch Structure structure without giving the opponent a free tactical or central improvement.

PRIMARY PLAN

Complete the essential development, identify the central commitment, and preserve the option that makes the full position useful.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks e4 and the bishop pair but must solve king safety.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4

MEMORY RULE

Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Kmoch Structure.

19. Decision Framework

Kmoch Structure - Move Order

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

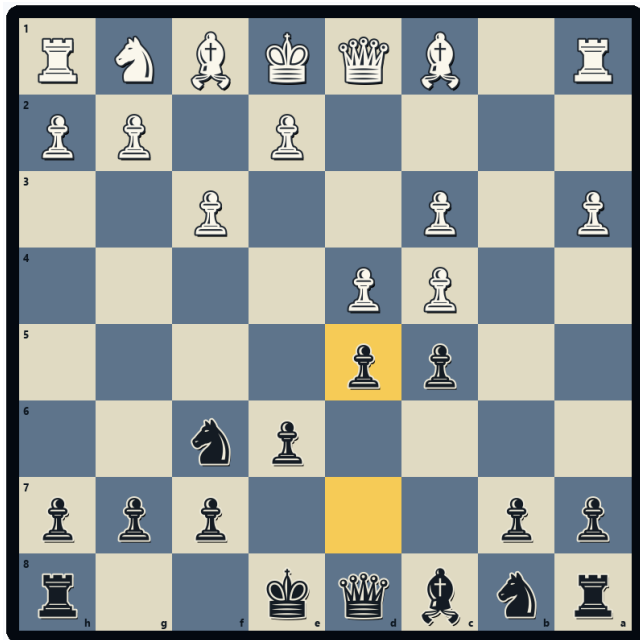
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Move-order rule: know what changes before steering toward Kmoch Structure.

20. Kmoch Structure



04 - Saemisch

READ THE POSITION

Both sides challenge the center before White completes development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open the center while White's king and pieces remain uncoordinated.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks e4 and the bishop pair but must solve king safety.

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. a3 Bxc3+ 5. bxc3 c5 6. f3 d5

MEMORY RULE

A broad center is vulnerable when the king cannot leave the middle.

20. Decision Framework

Kmoch Structure

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Before committing, check forcing replies, loose pieces, tactical pins, and the opponent's strongest central resource.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: A broad center is vulnerable when the king cannot leave the middle.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.